

Won-Jae Chang

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA 08/2026 — Present
Ph.D. Management Science (Technological Innovation, Entrepreneurship, and Strategic Management)

Princeton University, Princeton, NJ 08/2020 — 05/2024
B.A. Economics with Honors (Cum Laude), Minor in Applied Mathematics

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant: MIT FutureTech (Dr. Danial Lashkari and Dr. Neil Thompson)
Cambridge, MA 07/2025 — 06/2026

- Contributed to research on the economics of AI and innovation, including structural modeling of AI-driven automation, proof review for a QJE publication, and LLM-based generation of synthetic task attributes for model calibration.

Analyst: Cornerstone Research
New York, NY 08/2024 — 06/2025

- Conducted econometric analyses, managed large datasets, and created exhibits for 8+ corporate litigation and antitrust lawsuits across industries like fintech, life sciences, & consumer tech.

Research Assistant: Princeton Applied Mathematics (Dr. Marc Gilles & Dr. Amit Singer)
Princeton, NJ 05/2023 — 05/2024

- Designed, implemented, and optimized numerical linear algebra algorithms on Python to reconstruct 3D protein molecule structures from 2D images (Cryo-EM).

Research Assistant: Princeton Economics (Dr. Ellora Derenoncourt)
Princeton, NJ 08/2022 — 04/2023

- Contributed to “Wealth of Two Nations: The U.S. Racial Wealth Gap, 1860–2020” (QJE 2024). Conducted exploratory quantitative analysis through Stata and qualitative analysis through article and document review.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Princeton University

- Econometrics: A Mathematical Approach (ECO312) 09/2023 — 05/2024
- Introduction to Microeconomics (ECO100) 09/2022 — 12/2022

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PROJECTS

Senior Thesis: Productive Selectivity: Addressing the Quality-Retention Trade-Off in Student Group Admissions
Advised by: Dr. Fedor Sandomirskiy, Economics Dept. 04/2024

PACM Independent Work: Efficient algorithms for Ewald sphere correction in Cryo-EM
Advised by: Dr. Marc Gilles & Dr. Amit Singer, Math Dept. 04/2024

Junior Paper: The Relationship between Conservation-Oriented Tourism and Economic Well Being: Ecotourism in Costa Rica
Advised by: Dr. Smita Brunnermeier, Economics Dept. 04/2023

INTERNSHIPS

Finance Intern: Brightside (FinTech Startup)
Remote 06/2023 — 08/2023

- Built pricing models and ROI calculators for Brightside’s products, designed company budget templates on Tableau, and learned to navigate financial statements.

International Trade Intern: British Chamber of Commerce
Bogota, Colombia / Remote 06/2022 — 07/2022

- Qualitatively analyzed the bilateral economic relationship between Colombia and the U.K., creating exhibits and visualizations using excel and Tableau. Wrote a bilingual report on trade history and development between the two countries.

Summer Intern: RELX Group (Elsevier)
Seoul, S.K. & London, U.K. 05/2021 — 07/2021

- Investigated country economies, GDPs, exports/imports, and other relevant market information for Elsevier’s chairman in meetings and speaking events, and analyzed data using Excel about RX and their events’ adherence to the 17 UN SDGs.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Programming/Software: R, Python, Stata, Matlab, Java, TeX, SQL, Microsoft Office (Excel, Word, Powerpoint)

Languages: Korean (Fluent), Spanish (Proficient), Arabic (Elementary)

Personal Interests: Running, Cooking, Swimming, Soccer, Mentorship & Teaching, Pizza

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Leadership: Whig-Clio (President); Princeton Model UN Conference (Secretary-General)

Volunteering: Davis International Center (Orientation Leader), Camp Kesem Princeton (Camp Counselor), MIT Spark (Teacher)

Activities & Societies: Cap & Gown Club, Princeton Debate Panel, Asian American & Korean American Students Association